



All Google and a little of Firefox

There is hardly a month that has gone by since the early 20th century where Google didn't feature in our monthly web watch section, and this time is no exception. We've got other participants, from Mozilla's release of Firefox 6, to a little Facebook we almost chose to ignore.

Google makes 'the web faster'

Google launched its Page Speed Service in early August, enabling publishers to speed up how fast their web pages loaded, by 25 to 60%. Page speed, or page load time is not just a factor in the bounce rate of a web page, but also Google's own Page Rank of it. All this is a part of Google's "Make the Web Faster" campaign, which in the past included the Page Speed browser extension, the Page Speed Online API, the SPDY protocol, and the mod_pagespeed Apache module.

With the new service, Google will start web hosting publishers' content on their servers, and present a web-optimized version to users. Publishers hence will not have to worry about compressing their content, caching solutions, or other website optimization details – Google will take care of it for them, once the publishers have pointed their DNS entry to Google.

Games for Data

Google has added twelve games to Google+, including the ubiquitous Angry Birds and Zynga Poker, as a new Google+ Games service. However, to play them, users need to give permission to the app to view a variety of personal information, including the user's email address, basic infor-

mation about your account, and even a list of people that you have placed in your Circles, with the order or priority of them.

Facebook fights back

Google fired the first salvo, adding a dozen games to Google+ on Friday, but Facebook seems to have fired right back with new features that expand its own existing brand of social gameplay. While Facebook's gaming features may have been in the works for some time, it was certainly timed in such a way as to



take some of the wind out Google's social gaming sails.

The new Facebook gaming features include a larger gaming screen and a ticker that appears to the right of the screen which shows friends' gaming activity, scores, and achievement.

Google Chrome 13 released with new Instant Pages feature

Google has released the thirteenth version of its Chrome browser with a number of interesting new features. Continuing on its usual track to improve web browsing speed, Google Chrome 13 introduces a new Instant Pages feature. In cases where Google can accurately determine where the user might go next, it can begin loading that page in the

background and rendering it, so when the user clicks, the page is loaded instantly.

Google Chrome 13 also makes some improvements to the Omnibox that can also lead to speedier browsing. In Chrome 13, the Omnibox now taps into your browser history to offer matches from titles and URLs of previously visited websites.

The new version also adds one very unique feature – multi-selection of tabs. One can now select multiple tabs at a time (by pressing the Ctrl or Shift key

pressed) and perform some operations on them in bulk. You could select multiple tabs, and close them together, close all other tabs, duplicate the tabs, pin the tabs, or bookmark the selected tabs. You can even select multiple tabs and drag them together to another window or a new window.

Firefox 6 released

Mozilla has made its second rapid release; Firefox 6 is now available for download. As expected from this new release process, there are minor additions.

Firefox 6 should now load much faster if you are using Panorama. Firefox will no longer load tabs that are part of inactive Panorama groups. This means that your browser starts faster and becomes responsive faster as fewer websites are loaded to begin with. If you switch to a panorama group after loading Firefox, it will then begin loading tabs from that group.

Firefox now promotes the Firefox Sync feature while saving passwords or saving bookmarks. Another subtle new feature is that Firefox will now highlight the domain name in the addressbar, making it easier to ascertain which website you are visiting.

You can also check out a preview of Firefox 7 or 8 by downloading the Aurora or Nightly Firefox build. Remember that these can be very unstable at times and it is recommended you use them with a separate profile. **d**

